

Kudzaishe Zharare

kudzi@alum.mit.edu | kudzaishe.com | github.com/kudzaishezharare

Experience

Poza 2025 - Present

Founder and Software Engineer

- Led discovery through 56 merchant and payments-stakeholder interviews; translated findings into product requirements, user journeys, interface prototypes, and technical architecture.
- Built Flutter/Dart mobile apps, web interfaces, and TypeScript services on AWS, connecting account creation, identity verification, and financial account workflows.
- Built document verification using PaddleOCR, passport and barcode validation, and facial matching; integrated AWS Rekognition liveness checks into onboarding.
- Implemented Airwallex payment and card integrations, a PostgreSQL wallet ledger with deposit matching and reconciliation, and Alpaca brokerage onboarding, funding, and orders in sandbox.

Cleva Technologies (YC W24) Apr 2024 - 2025

Lead Software Engineer

- Automated KYC with Veriff and an in-house flow, cutting waits of 2 days to 3 weeks to under a minute for eligible completed submissions; infrastructure supported growth beyond 1 million users.
- Built Nigerian NIN verification with OCR and AWS Rekognition; detected duplicate accounts through face search and routed uncertain cases to reviewers with explicit reasons.
- Designed a configurable JSON Logic engine for approximately 100 evolving KYC rules, enabling policy updates and feature flags with deterministic approval, denial, and manual-review outcomes.

FlexID Technologies 2021 - 2023

CTO, later Co-Founder

- Led a distributed engineering team building identity wallets across Android, web, and WhatsApp, with Algorand and verifiable credentials; owned architecture, cloud infrastructure, APIs, and SDKs.

Motapa, trading as Mutapa 2019 - 2021

Founder and Systems Architect

- Led a five-person team on CBZ's contracted 200-merchant programme, delivering iVeri integrations across education, retail, healthcare, and public institutions; coordinated bank liaison and merchant training.
- Supported card and EcoCash payments through 2022; later added 3D Secure, Cybersource, and Zim-switch. Built Mutapa Marketplace, acquired by CBZ Holdings.

The World Bank 2019 - 2020

Country Lead Engineer, DRIVER Project

- Built Zimbabwe's crash-reporting application and national dashboards; led rollout with police, ambulance services, and the Ministry of Health.

Skills

Full-stack: TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, React, Vue, Node.js, Django, REST APIs

Mobile and UI: Flutter, Dart, React Native, Android, Figma, HTML/CSS

Infrastructure: AWS, CDK, Lambda, Linux, Docker, Git, CI/CD

Data and systems: PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Redis, webhooks, OCR, AI agent architecture

Project management: Requirements, delivery planning, stakeholder coordination

Leadership: Team leadership, technical documentation, merchant training

Education

Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2019

B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics